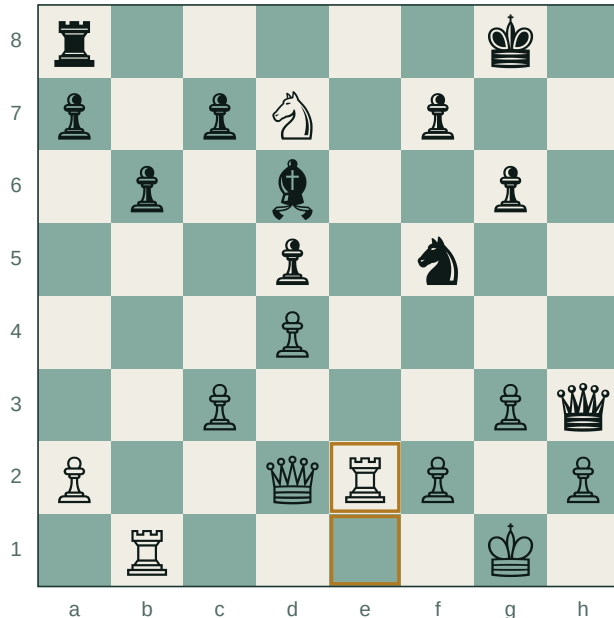


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 23

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Re2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Nh4 24. Nf6+ Kg7

23...Nh4 The knight moves from f5 to h4. The changed line means the queen on h3 attacks the knight on d7. Recorded reply: **24.Nf6+**.

24...Kg7 The king moves from g8 to g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: knight on d7 and rook on b1. Check for tactical protection.